# Japan Portfolio Brief — Friday, November 13, 2026

This brief covers the Thu Nov 12 US session and the Fri Nov 13 Tokyo and Seoul sessions, both closed. Nov 13 was the biggest results day of the season for the bank names, and also a Japanese futures/options settlement (SQ) day.

**Data-quality warning (continuing):** all research came from search-result summaries. WebFetch could not reach kabutan, nikkei.com, Sedaily, investinglive, fxstreet or japex.co.jp from this environment, so no primary filing (tanshin/DART) was opened. Figures are press- or aggregator-reported. "QUIET" means nothing was found, not that the name is confirmed quiet. Several results landed after the Tokyo close, so the first price reaction is **Monday Nov 16**.

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## 1. Top of the stack

**1. Jensen Huang resigned from Nvidia. SoftBank fell another ~5% to ¥3,547 — down about 8% over two sessions — while Japanese chip stocks rebounded.**

- **What happened.** Huang resigned as CEO, president and director on Nov 12, effective immediately. CFO Colette Kress is interim CEO while the board searches for a permanent one. Earlier the WSJ had reported the board was preparing to oust him; the background is reported affairs, one involving a woman US authorities suspect of spying for China (CNBC, CNBC live, CoinDesk). **This resolves yesterday's "unconfirmed ouster" item.**
- **US.** NVDA fell as much as about 14% intraday and closed -4.34%. S&P 500 -0.35% to 7,592.40; Nasdaq -0.39%; AMD +5.9%, Broadcom +5.5% (Euronext/Reuters, Epoch Times).
- **Tokyo.** The Nikkei rose 0.53% to 61,142.35, after being up more than ¥1,000 intraday. TOPIX +0.11% to 3,941.57 (Zaikei, Kabutan). Over the week the Nikkei gained about 6.5%, its best week in five months (rallies.ai). Fast Retailing and Advantest led the index.
- **SoftBank (9984).** Closed ¥3,547 (about -5.1%). It was the largest drag on the Nikkei, at about -154 points (AP via KSAT, Kabutan contribution). No SoftBank-specific news was found. The move reads as OpenAI and AI-leadership risk concentrating in SoftBank, while the chip names were bought.
- **Korea.** KOSPI -0.98% to 5,290.53 after reaching about 5,500 intraday. Foreigners sold a net ₩703bn, led by SK hynix (fnnews, Hankyung). KOSDAQ +0.45% to 699.66.
- **Next.** Nvidia's Q3 on Nov 17 will be the first under the interim CEO; whether that date holds is unconfirmed. A congressional briefing for Huang on Nov 18 is reported but unconfirmed (CNN).
- **Verdict: MATTERS** for SoftBank and NAVER. The semi-adjacent names (RS Technologies, MegaChips, Sanken) look less exposed so far, because the Japanese chip complex rallied.

**2. The yen broke 160 and Finance Minister Katayama threatened action. December BoJ hike odds rose to about 87% and the 10y JGB yield reached 2.87%. The JGB 466 reinvestment decision is now overdue.**

- **Yen.** USD/JPY traded through 160 on Nov 13 (about 160.03), its first break since early September, then eased to about 159.9. Katayama called the moves "one-sided and rapid" and said Japan will work closely with the US Treasury and "respond appropriately" (Bloomberg, The Standard). **No intervention has been confirmed.** The precedent is ¥15.4tn spent from Jul 30 to Aug 3 at about 164, with the US joining.
- **JGBs.** The 10y rose 7–8bp to 2.87% as the US Treasury sell-off spread to Japan (Bloomberg). The 30y was about 3.99–4.01% (sources conflict). The 2y was 1.88% (+1.9bp; single source, Substack).

- **BoJ.** OIS puts the December hike (1.25% → 1.50%) at about **87%**, up from about 82% a day earlier and about 50% last week. That is despite Asada's dovish speech on Nov 12, which hot October PPI (+7.1% y/y) outweighed (Bloomberg, Investing.com).
- **US driver.** A Fed hike on Dec 8–9 is fully priced. The US 2y rose about 34bp over two sessions to about 4.86%, and the 10y is about 5.10% (CNBC).
- **Verdict: MATTERS.** Intervention is now a live, near-term risk to the exporters (Honda, Subaru, Suzuki, Canon, Kubota) and the yen-sensitive miners.

**3. Bank results: MUFG raised its target and added a ¥200bn buyback. SMTG rose about 5.6% on its raise. The regionals came in at or above plan.**

- **MUFG (8306).** H1 net profit ¥1,630.8bn, +26.1%, a record. The full-year target rose from ¥2.7tn to ¥2.8tn, and the annual dividend from ¥96 to ¥100. It announced a buyback of up to ¥200bn or 70m shares, running Nov 16 to Jan 29 (Nikkei, stockexpress). One report says the new target is still below consensus (unverified). The stock's close conflicts across sources (¥3,475 or ¥3,527).
- **SMTG (8309).** Reported Nov 12: H1 net ¥250.1bn (+46%); full-year raised from ¥380bn to ¥420bn; dividend from ¥47.5 to ¥51. **The ¥50bn buyback is confirmed** (up to 45m shares, Nov 13 to Mar 31, all to be cancelled). The stock was up about 5.6% on Nov 13, from a single source (media-ir, Finimize).
- **Japan Post (6178).** H1 net ¥232.2bn (+62.9%). The full-year target of ¥380bn was kept, and is 61% achieved. The postal/logistics loss widened to ¥55.8bn. No new buyback (LNEWS).
- **Kyoto FG (5844).** H1 net ¥34.6bn (+28.8%), a record and about 25% above its H1 plan. Nikkei says the ¥52bn full-year plan is below consensus; whether the plan was revised is unverified (Tokyo Shimbun, NHK).
- **The regionals** are covered in Section 2.
- **Verdict: MATTERS.** These are capital-return events, and the BoJ hike odds strengthen the earnings case for the banks.

**4. Results after the close (reaction Monday): Appier beat and raised again; Yakult cut guidance; Obara set a record and raised its dividend; Mitsubishi Materials' official +6.2% move is confirmed.**

- **Appier (4180).** Q3 revenue rose 21.8% to ¥13.9bn, a record, and operating profit 104.7% to ¥2.1bn. Full-year guidance and the dividend forecast were raised again; the new figures were not visible (PR Times).
- **Yakult (2267).** H1 recurring profit fell 9.4% to ¥32.8bn. Full-year guidance was cut: sales from ¥527bn to ¥510bn, recurring profit from ¥57.5bn to ¥55.5bn (Kabutan, Yakult PDF). Reports of a ¥100bn+ buyback and a total payout above 80% are **unverified** as to date and scope (Investing.com JP).
- **Obara (6877).** FY9/26 ordinary profit ¥13.36bn (+31%), about 13% above guidance. FY9/27 guidance is ordinary profit ¥14.1bn (+5.6%), and the dividend rises to ¥170 (+¥20) (Kabutan). Not yet checked on TDnet.
- **Mitsubishi Materials (5711).** The official Nov 12 close was ¥4,390 (+6.24%), after its second guidance raise of the year (recurring profit from ¥180bn to ¥220bn). The dividend was **not** revised; returns will be decided after an investment review. The stock gave back about 1.9% on Nov 13 to about ¥4,307 (Kabutan, minkabu).

**5. LG Corp's Q3 was hit by LG Chem's loss. SK Discovery posted a record quarter on stake sales. NAVER's targets were cut.**

- **LG Corp (003550).** Q3 operating profit ₩327.7bn (-21.8%) and net ₩256.5bn (-31.3%). Equity-method income roughly halved, to ₩107.7bn, because LG Chem lost about ₩600bn (Asia Economy).
- **SK Discovery (006120).** Revenue ₩3.44tn (+32%) and pretax profit ₩368.7bn (+311%), both records. The pretax jump is mostly a one-off: about ₩1.6tn raised from selling minority stakes in power subsidiaries. Cash is now

₩3.85tn (Herald).

- **NAVER (035420).** Brokers cut targets after the Q3 miss: Hana to ₩340k, KIS to ₩300k, Meritz to ₩270k (Ajunews, eToday). Q3 free cash flow was -₩151bn (TheElec).

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## 2. What matters, by theme

### Macro thread — week in context (BoJ, JGBs, yen, BoK, won)

- **BoJ.**
  - The policy rate is 1.25%. The Oct 29–30 meeting voted 8–1 to hold, with Takata dissenting for 1.5% (Bloomberg).
  - This week: Asada (dovish, Nov 12), October PPI 7.1%, and December OIS odds up from about 50% to about 87%.
  - Next: Q3 GDP on Nov 16 (Reuters poll +0.3% annualised, consumption -0.2%; IndexBox), Takata's speech on Nov 16, and October CPI on Nov 20 (core seen at 2.3%; Reuters poll).
- **JGBs.**
  - 10y 2.87%, 30y about 4.0%, 2y about 1.88%. The bear move was imported from Treasuries.
  - A second FY2026 supplementary budget, limited to urgent and disaster items, is being compiled; its size is unknown (single source, BigGo).
  - The next 2y auction is around Nov 30 (single source, saiken.net).
- **Yen.** It broke 160, and the Katayama/Mimura jawboning has escalated to "work with the US Treasury". Intervention is the main tail event for the exporters.
- **Korea.**
  - The won was about 1,336.7/USD (6 won weaker; Sedaily).
  - The BoK base rate is 3.00%. Consensus is a 25bp hike at the late-November meeting; the Nov 26 date is still unconfirmed by source (Korea Times).
  - October CPI was 2.8%. Exports for Nov 1–10 roughly doubled, with chips +331% (Korea Times).
- **Korea market structure.**
  - The MSCI November review (effective after the Nov 30 close) made no Korea Standard changes and affects none of our names. SK hynix gets about ₩580bn of passive buying (eToday).
  - Nothing new on the Commercial Act treasury-share cancellation mandate.

### Megacaps / tech

- **SoftBank (9984): MATTERS.** See Top 1. The share price is now about 8% lower than before the Nvidia news.
- **Appier (4180): MATTERS (positive).** See Top 4. The previous full-year operating-profit guide was ¥5.03bn; confirm the new number on TDnet.
- **Universal Entertainment (6425): MATTERS (mixed).** Nine months: sales ¥106.6bn (+15%), operating profit ¥11.5bn, ordinary profit back in the black at ¥0.7bn. The Jul–Sep quarterly loss widened. The full-year guide is unchanged (operating profit ¥16bn, ordinary profit ¥2.2bn) (Kabutan).
- **Optex (6914): UNVERIFIED.** Q3 was due at 15:30 Nov 13; no result was found. The full-year operating-profit guide is ¥10.5bn against consensus of about ¥11.3bn (Kabutan). Check TDnet.
- **RS Technologies (3445): QUIET.** Q3 is due "mid-November". It reported on Nov 13 last year, so it may already be out. H1 ordinary profit was 52% of the ¥17.2bn guide (kabuyoho).

- **Sony (6758): QUIET.** As of Oct 31 it had bought back ¥309bn of shares (6-K).
- **Sanken (6707), MegaChips (6875), SHIFT (3697): QUIET.** No new items. Sanken's H1 loss was already flagged.
- **Keyence (6861), Canon (7751), Seiko Epson (6724), Omron (6645), Daikin (6367): QUIET.** No dated news. They likely moved with the chip/FA rebound and the weak yen (unverified).

### Banks / financials

- **MUFG (8306), SMTG (8309), Japan Post (6178), Kyoto FG (5844): MATTERS.** See Top 3.
- **North Pacific Bank (8524, 北洋銀行): MATTERS (in line).** H1 ordinary profit ¥24.9bn (+35.9%), 48.9% of the ¥51.1bn full-year plan, which was already raised on Oct 28 along with a dividend increase to ¥36.5 (Kabutan, Oct 28).
- **Kita-Nippon Bank (8551): NOISE.** Reported Nov 12: H1 ordinary profit ¥3.62bn (+17.4%), but the Jul–Sep quarter fell 30%. The ¥6.6bn full-year plan is unchanged and implies a weaker H2 (Kabutan).
- **Fidea (8713): NOISE.** H1 ordinary profit ¥4.21bn (2.1x), already 87.7% of the unchanged ¥4.8bn plan. The plan looks conservative, so a raise is possible later (Kabutan).
- **Shimizu Bank (8364): UNVERIFIED.** The actual H1 was not found. On Oct 26 it had raised H1 ordinary profit guidance to ¥3.4bn, full-year to ¥4.7bn, and the dividend by ¥10 (Kabutan).
- **Resona (8308): QUIET.** Settlement of the 5% MACP stake (due Nov 13) was not confirmed (MACP). Kyodo reports Resona was the only one of the five big banks without a record H1 (Yahoo/Kyodo). Its own numbers were not reviewed this run.
- **SBI (8473): QUIET.** About +1.3% at midday; no news.

### Industrials / autos / resources / real estate

- **Mitsubishi Materials (5711): MATTERS.** See Top 4.
- **JAPEX (1662): MATTERS (unverified).** H1 results and a forecast revision came out Nov 12, followed by an analyst briefing on Nov 13. The **direction and size of the revision could not be read** (revision PDF). Exploration costs rose to ¥4.3bn. Brent at about $95–96 is supportive (FinanceFeeds).
- **Yakult (2267): MATTERS (negative).** See Top 4.
- **Sumitomo Metal Mining (5713): NOISE in the window.** On Nov 10 it cut full-year net to ¥161bn (a ¥42.6bn Coral Bay impairment) and added a ¥30bn buyback (Mining.com). Copper is at a 3-month low of about $13,650/t (Business Recorder).
- **Suzuki (7269): NOISE (mildly positive).** A broker kept its top rating and raised its target on Nov 13 (Kabutan). The ADR had gapped down after the Nov 10 results.
- **Honda (7267): NOISE.** Up about 1–2% on the weak yen. EV charges are already known (Nikkei).
- **Keisei (9009): NOISE.** Hit a year-to-date high of ¥1,524 intraday. Keisei says it keeps its ~20% Oriental Land stake; Palliser is pushing for a reduction (LIMO).
- **Mitsui Fudosan (8801): NOISE.** A small bounce after the Nov 9 sell-off. Rising JGB yields are the headwind.
- **Subaru (7270), Kubota (6326), Shibaura Machine (6104), JR Central (9022), Shochiku (9601): QUIET.** Results for each were already covered in earlier briefs. Shibaura's H1 figures conflict across sources.
- **US auto tariffs:** nothing new; the rate stays at 15%.

### Japan small / mid caps

- **Obara (6877): MATTERS (positive).** See Top 4.

- **Tokyotokeiba (9672): UNVERIFIED.** Q3 was due Nov 13; no numbers were found. H1 ordinary profit was 46.7% of the ¥15.86bn guide. It raised guidance at last year's Q3 (kabuyoho).
- **Katakura (3001): QUIET.** No new large-holder filing; the last was Zenner at 5.04% in May. The stock is easing from its ¥4,130 record of Nov 5 to about ¥3,765. Q3 results Nov 16 (Japan IR).
- **Nakayama Steel (5408): QUIET, ownership worth watching.** Hanwa Kogyo now holds 20.0% and Yodoko 10.7%, about 31% combined (October filings; Matsui).
- **Oro (3983): QUIET.** Q3 results Nov 16. It cut guidance at last year's Q3, so this is a risk (Monex).
- **Ebara Jitsugyo (6328), Fudo Tetra (1813), KH Neochem (4189), Valqua (7995), Tigers Polymer (4231), TOC (8841), Hi-Lex (7279): QUIET.** All reported before this window. Valqua's H1 appears above guide (aggregator only; EDINET DB). Hi-Lex's full-year date of Dec 11 is still unverified; it reported Dec 8–9 in past years.

### Korea names

- **LG Corp (003550), SK Discovery (006120), NAVER (035420): MATTERS.** See Top 5.
- **LG Chem pref (051915): MATTERS (no new event).** The ~₩2.5tn LGES PRS cash arrives Nov 27. ₩300bn of buybacks and cancellations (common and preferred) and ₩100bn of dividends follow (Econovill). Its Q3 net loss of about ₩600bn is what drove the LG Corp miss.
- **ILJIN Holdings (015860): MINOR.** Subsidiary ILJIN Electric's Q3 operating profit was ₩70bn (+98%) on UK grid orders (fnnews). The holdco files by Nov 16.
- **SK Inc (034730), LS Corp (006260): NOT YET FOUND.** Their Q3 filings are due around Nov 14–16. The subsidiaries are strong: SK Innovation's operating profit was a record ₩3.70tn, and LS Electric's a record ₩233.5bn (Herald, Newspim). **The LS Q3 operating profit of ₩257.1bn circulating in search is the 2025 figure.**
- **Taekwang (003240): QUIET.** No audit-committee reply to Truston was found at the ~Nov 12 deadline (MTN). Watch for Truston to escalate.
- **Samsung C&T (028260): QUIET.** About +2.7% intraday; no news.
- **Hyosung (004800), Amorepacific Group (002790), F&F (383220), LG Electronics pref (066575): QUIET.** All reported before this window.
- **Misto (081660):** Q3 expected around Nov 16–17; watch the Acushnet result and the dividend.
- **Eusu (000700), Daewon Sanup (005710), Motonic (009680), Seoul City Gas (017390), Samyang Tongsang (002170), Ubiquoss (078070): QUIET.** Q3 filings are due by Nov 16.

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## 3. Probably noise

- **"MUFG closed -0.66%" vs "+0.83%":** sources conflict. Wait for Monday's reaction to the buyback.
- **"Kyoto FG 1-for-4 split and forecast raise":** a stale November 2023 item.
- **"LS Corp Q3 OP ₩257.1bn":** the 2025 figure again.
- **"Taekwang Q3 OP ₩4.9bn":** a different company (023160).
- **Shibaura Machine "¥8,003m" profit:** conflicts with Kabutan; aggregator error.
- **MSCI November review:** no changes affecting our names.
- **"Huang summoned to testify":** headline framing; the date and format are unconfirmed.
- **The Prime top gainer on Nov 13 (a limit-up tender-offer rumour):** not one of our names, as far as can be told; the name was not visible.

## 4. Time-sensitive / positions watch

**JGB No. 466 (0.50%, JP1024661QB1): matured Sun Nov 1; settlement still unverified, 12 days on.**

- **New this run:** HSBC securities-lending reports map **JP1024661QB1 to "JPGV 0.500 11/01/26 JAPAN"**. This independently confirms the coupon and maturity for this ISIN (HSBC). Combined with the MOF No. 466 terms (MOF), the ISIN-to-No. 466 link is now strongly supported, though no single source names both.
- **Payment date:** still unsourced. Mon Nov 2 is the next business day after Sunday Nov 1.
- **Decisions:**
    1. Get the custodian to confirm redemption.
    2. Make the **overdue** reinvestment decision. The 2y is about 1.88%, against the old 0.5% coupon, and the 10y is 2.87%. With about 87% priced for a December hike, the front end already discounts most of it. Yen intervention would likely rally JGBs. Waiting for GDP (Nov 16) and CPI (Nov 20) is defensible; waiting past the Dec 17–18 meeting gives up carry.
    3. Remove the position from `watchlist-japan.md` once redemption is confirmed. **It stays on the watchlist and is flagged, not dropped.**

**Open identity question for owner: 8551 vs 8524.**

- **Re-confirmed:** 8524 = 北洋銀行 (North Pacific Bank, Sapporo; J-LIC); 8551 = 北日本銀行 (Kita-Nippon Bank; Kabutan).
- **Both banks have now reported:** North Pacific in line with a raised plan; Kita-Nippon with a weak Q2. **Coverage still follows the 8551 ticker.** Please confirm which bank is held.

**Watchlist updates made this run (no identity changes):**

- SMTG's ¥50bn buyback is confirmed.
- Mitsubishi Materials' Nov 12 close of +6.24% is confirmed, with no dividend change.
- Obara's FY results are in.
- The JGB ISIN gains a new corroborating source.

**Portfolio-level:**

- Concentration risk: SoftBank is the portfolio's single most Nvidia/OpenAI-exposed name.
- Intervention risk at 160 cuts against the exporters and the miners.
- Bank capital returns, from MUFG and SMTG, are the offset.

*Calendar ( = aggregator/inferred/unconfirmed):**

- **Nov 14–16:** Korea Q3 filing deadline (SK Inc, LS Corp, ILJIN Holdings, Taekwang, Misto*, Eusu, Daewon, Motonic, Seoul City Gas, Samyang Tongsang, Ubiquoss)
- **Mon Nov 16:**
    - Japan Q3 GDP (08:50)
    - BoJ Takata speech
    - Katakura Q3
    - Oro Q3
    - RS Technologies Q3*
    - MUFG buyback starts
    - First trading reaction to Appier, Yakult, Obara, Universal, Optex, Tokyotokeiba and JAPEX

- **Nov 17:**
  - Nvidia Q3* (date under the interim CEO unconfirmed)
  - MUFG investor briefing
- **Nov 18:**
  - SMTG investor briefing
  - Huang congressional briefing*
- **Nov 20:** Japan October CPI
- **Nov 24:** BoJ core CPI measures
- **Nov 26:**
  - Bank of Korea decision* (hike expected)
  - BoJ Tamura speech*
- **Nov 27:** LGES PRS cash to LG Chem
- **Nov 30:**
  - MSCI changes effective
  - 2y JGB auction*
- **Dec 1:** LG Chem buyback trust begins*
- **Dec 8–9:** FOMC (hike priced)
- **Dec 11:**
  - KH Neochem treasury-share cancellation
  - Hi-Lex full-year results*
- **Dec 17–18:** BoJ meeting

**Undated but live:** yen intervention; the Nvidia CEO search and investigation; the Truston–Taekwang dispute; the Keisei/Oriental Land stake and Palliser; Nakayama Steel's ~31% held by two steel companies; Mitsubishi Materials' shareholder-return review; the size of Japan's supplementary budget.

## 5. Follow-up questions to investigate

- **JGB 466:** has the custodian confirmed redemption, and what is the reinvestment instruction (tenor, and whether to wait for CPI on Nov 20)?
- **8551 vs 8524:** which bank is actually held?
- **SoftBank:** what is its direct exposure to Nvidia leadership change through OpenAI, Stargate and its Nvidia stake? Is there a CDS print after Nov 6?
- **MUFG:** how far is the ¥2.8tn target below consensus, and what was the actual Nov 13 close?
- **Yakult:** is the ¥100bn+ buyback new, and over what period does it run?
- **JAPEX:** what are the direction and size of the Nov 12 forecast revision (TDnet)?
- **Optex, Tokyotokeiba, Shimizu Bank, Resona:** pull the actual Nov 13 tanshin numbers.
- **Appier:** what is the new full-year operating-profit guide?
- **Mitsubishi Materials:** when will the shareholder-return review conclude?
- **SK Discovery:** how will the ₩3.85tn cash pile be used (buyback or dividend)?
- **Taekwang:** did the audit committee reply to Truston, and what is Truston's next step?
- **Nakayama Steel:** what are Hanwa's and Yodoko's intentions now that they hold ~31% combined?

- **Network access:** allowing kabutan.jp, nikkei.com, jpx.co.jp/TDnet, dart.fss.or.kr, mof.go.jp and sedaily.com in the environment's network policy would allow primary-source verification.